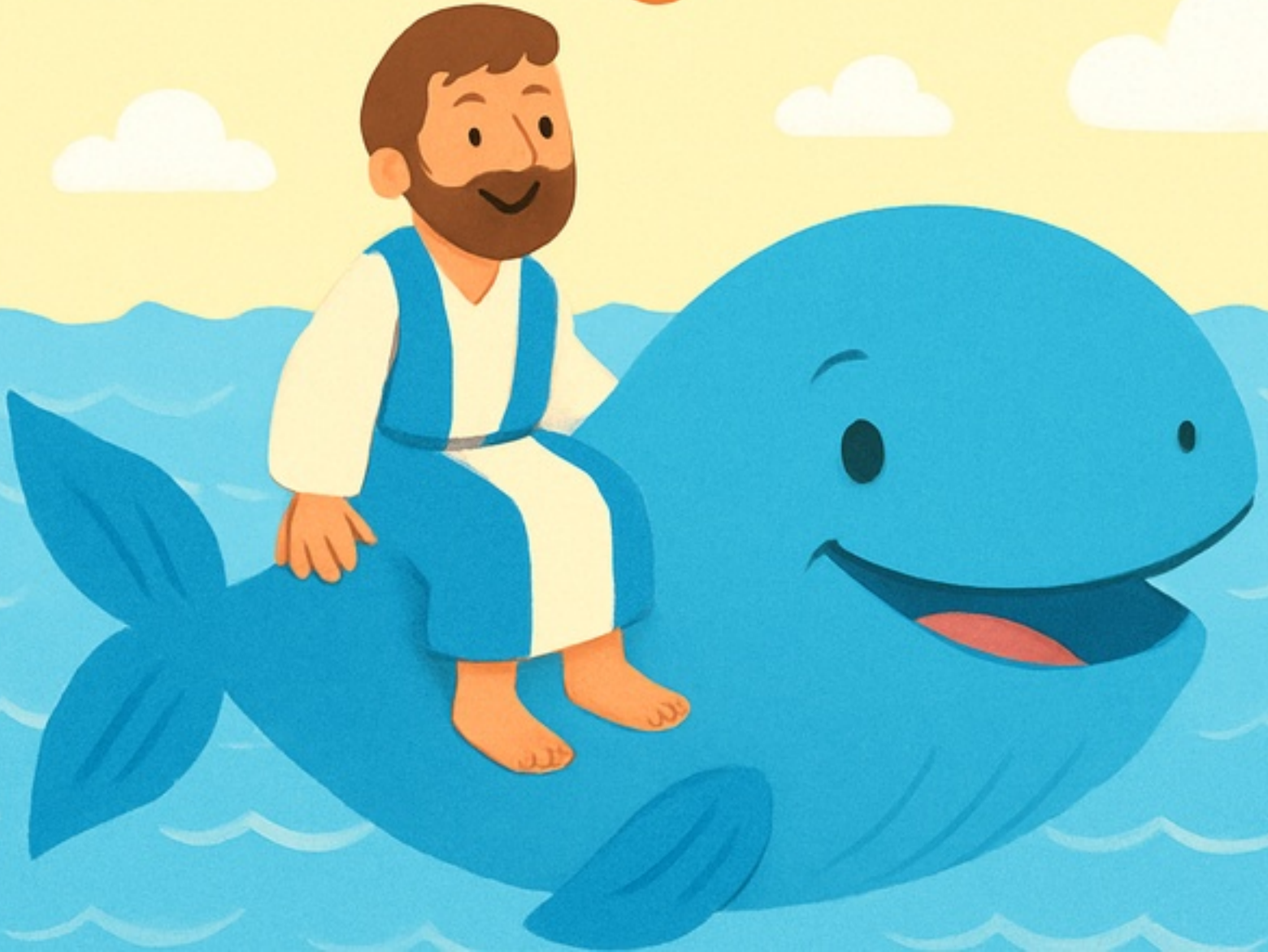


Jonah and the Big Fish

A StorySprout Press Book







Long ago, there lived a man named Jonah. Jonah loved God, but sometimes he found it hard to listen.



One day, God said, "Jonah, please go to the city of Nineveh. Tell the people there that I love them."



But Jonah did not want to go to Nineveh. He decided to run away instead!



Jonah went down to the big blue sea. He found a sturdy wooden boat.



"Where are you going?" the Captain asked. "Far away!" Jonah said. He hopped onto the boat.



The boat sailed out into the deep water. Jonah went downstairs to take a long nap.



Suddenly, the sky turned grey. *Whoosh!* The wind began to blow. *Splash!* The waves grew big.



The sailors were afraid. "The sea is very grumpy today!" they cried.



Jonah woke up and came upstairs. He knew why the sea was grumpy. "I am running away from God," he said quietly.



"If you throw me into the water, the sea will be calm again," Jonah told them.



The sailors tried to row to land, but the waves were too big. Finally, they gently lifted Jonah and... *Splash!*



As soon as Jonah hit the water, the wind stopped. The sea became smooth and quiet again.



But Jonah was under the water! *Gurgle, gurgle.*
Just then, a very Big Fish swam by.



Gulp! The Big Fish swallowed Jonah whole!



Inside the Big Fish, it wasn't scary at all. It was warm and dark, like a cozy cave.



Jonah sat down on a soft spot. He had a lot of time to think.



"I'm sorry, God," Jonah prayed. "I should have listened to you. Please give me another chance."



Jonah stayed inside the Big Fish for three whole days. He sang songs and talked to God.



God heard Jonah's prayer. He spoke to the Big Fish. "It's time to let Jonah go," God said.



The Big Fish swam close to the shore. *Wiggle, wiggle, burp!* Jonah flew out onto the dry sand.



"Thank you, Big Fish!" Jonah called out. The fish wiggled its tail and swam back into the sea.



This time, Jonah listened! He walked all the way to Nineveh and told everyone about God's love.



Jonah was happy because he listened to God. And
God was happy because Jonah was his friend.

About the Story

Jonah learns that running away isn't the answer. After being swallowed by a friendly Big Fish, he prays for a second chance and discovers that God always listens.

Ages 2-6 | StorySprout Press

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